

The Broke But Fed Playbook

Eat well on \$50/week. No chef skills required.

THE \$50 WEEKLY GROCERY LIST

Hit these staples and you can make 90% of the recipes in this guide. Shop at Walmart, Aldi, or Trader Joe's for best prices.

PROTEINS (\$15)

- !Eggs (12-pack) — \$2-3
- !Rotisserie chicken — \$7
- !Canned tuna/salmon (4 cans) — \$5
- !Ground beef or chicken thighs (1 lb) — \$4-6

CARBS (\$10)

- !Rice (2 lb bag) — \$2
- !Pasta (2 boxes) — \$3
- !Bread (1 loaf) — \$2-3
- !Oats (container) — \$3

PRODUCE (\$12)

- !Bananas — \$1
- !Apples (bag) — \$3
- !Spinach/mixed greens (bag) — \$3
- !Broccoli (bag) — \$2
- !Sweet potatoes (3) — \$3

PANTRY (\$10)

- !Olive oil, salt, pepper, garlic powder, hot sauce
- !Soy sauce, peanut butter, honey
- !Black beans/chickpeas (2 cans) — \$3
- !Pasta sauce (jar) — \$2-3

Total: ~\$47-50. This feeds one person for a full week with variety.

4-WEEK MEAL PLAN OVERVIEW

WEEK 1: Foundation Week — Master the basics

- !Breakfast: Oatmeal with banana (daily) OR eggs + toast
- !Lunch: Rotisserie chicken + rice + frozen veggies
- !Dinner: Pasta with marinara + ground beef
- !Snacks: Apples + peanut butter, trail mix

WEEK 2: Variety Week — Same ingredients, different flavors

- !Breakfast: Scrambled eggs 3 days, overnight oats 4 days
- !Lunch: Tuna salad wraps + apple
- !Dinner: Fried rice with egg and veggies (use leftover rice)

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30 EASY RECIPES UNDER \$3 PER SERVING

BREAKFAST (5 recipes)

- !OVERNIGHT OATS: 1/2 cup oats + 1 cup milk + banana, refrigerate overnight. No cooking.
- !EGG FRIED RICE: scrambled eggs in pan, add leftover rice, soy sauce, hot sauce. 5 minutes.
- !PEANUT BUTTER BANANA TOAST: toast + PB + banana slices + honey drizzle. Zero cooking.
- !VEGGIE OMELETTE: 3 eggs + spinach + whatever veggies you have, fold in pan. 8 minutes.
- !SMOOTHIE: frozen banana + milk + PB + oats in a blender. 2 minutes.

LUNCH (10 recipes)

- !TUNA MELT: tuna + mayo + bread + cheese, microwave or pan. 5 minutes.
- !CHICKEN RICE BOWL: rotisserie chicken + rice + any sauce + hot sauce. 3 minutes.
- !PASTA SALAD: cold pasta + tuna/chicken + olive oil + veggies. Make on Sunday, eat all week.
- !QUESADILLA: tortilla + cheese + beans + whatever protein, pan on medium. 4 minutes.
- !VEGGIE WRAP: tortilla + hummus + spinach + any veggies. No cooking.
- !RAMEN UPGRADE: ramen + egg + spinach + soy sauce + sesame oil. 5 minutes.
- !RICE AND BEANS: rice + black beans + hot sauce + lime. Dirt cheap, insanely filling.
- !CHICKEN SALAD: rotisserie chicken + mayo + celery on bread. 5 minutes.
- !FRIED EGG SANDWICH: fried egg + cheese + hot sauce on toast. 5 minutes.
- !LENTIL SOUP: lentils + broth + garlic + cumin in a pot, 20 min. Feeds you 3 days.

DINNER (10 recipes)

- !ONE-PAN CHICKEN: chicken thighs + diced sweet potato + broccoli + olive oil, 400°F, 30 min.
- !PASTA ARRABIATA: pasta + marinara + red pepper flakes + garlic. 15 minutes.
- !STIR FRY: protein + any veggies + soy sauce + rice. 10 minutes.
- !TACOS: ground beef/chicken + taco seasoning (50¢ packet) + tortillas. 15 minutes.
- !SWEET POTATO CHILI: sweet potato + beans + canned tomatoes + chili powder. 25 minutes.
- !EGG FRIED RICE (dinner version): add more protein, more veggies. Still 10 minutes.
- !SHEET PAN SAUSAGE: sausage + peppers + onions + potatoes, roast at 425°F.
- !PASTA AGLIO E OLIO: pasta + garlic + olive oil + red pepper. Simple and amazing.
- !CHICKEN SOUP: rotisserie chicken + broth + rice + carrots. 20 minutes.
- !BEAN BURRITO BOWL: beans + rice + corn + salsa + cheese. No cooking required.

SNACKS (\$1 or less each)

- !Apple + peanut butter (\$0.50)
- !Hard-boiled egg (\$0.25)
- !Banana + peanut butter (\$0.40)
- !Carrots + hummus (\$0.60)
- !Rice cake + PB (\$0.40)
- !Trail mix (buy in bulk) (\$0.50)
- !Popcorn (microwave bag) (\$0.40)
- !Greek yogurt (\$0.80)
- !Cottage cheese + fruit (\$0.75)
- !Edamame (frozen, microwave) (\$0.60)

DINING HALL HACKS

- !Build a bowl: get a base (rice/pasta), pile protein + veggies. Better than random plate.

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MEAL PREP SUNDAY SYSTEM (2 HOURS = WHOLE WEEK)

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